

考研精读 | The Guardian



Changes to vet practice rules 'put pet owners at risk of being ripped off'

兽医守则更改恐令养宠者口袋空空

难度评级: ★★★☆☆

【 Para.1 】

Pet owners have been warned they risk being ripped off by **private equity** firms that have bought local **veterinary** clinics after the Competition and Markets Authority (CMA) removed requirements for multinational companies to **disclose** which practices they owned.

英国竞争与市场管理局（CMA）近日取消了对跨国公司披露旗下兽医诊所所有权信息的要求。宠物主人因而被告诫称他们有可能会被收购多家当地兽医诊所的私募股权公司宰客。

【 Para.2 】

The CMA recently ran an investigation into the **monopolisation** of vet practices and found the lack of competition and **transparency** of ownership had led to high prices and a lack of information for customers. Pet owners

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文章导读：

英国六成兽医诊所被私募及大型集团收购，连锁机构收费比独立诊所高出 16.6%。竞争监管机构 CMA 出台改革方案，拟设置宠物处方费上限，但放宽所有权披露要求，允许使用品牌而非母公司名称。行业机构 PVA 对此提出异议，威胁发起司法审查，双方就消费者知情权产生分歧。

rip off phrase If someone rips you off, they cheat you by charging you too much money for something or by selling you something that is broken or damaged. 宰人; 坑人

The bigger, more reputable online casinos are not going to **rip you off**. 规模更大、声誉更好的网上赌场不会宰你。

rip-off n. If you say that something that you bought was a rip-off, you mean that you were charged too much money or that it was of very poor quality. 宰人货

The service charge is a **rip-off**, but I'm willing to pay if I'm guaranteed a seat. 这项服务费是宰人的，但要是能保证我有座位我就愿意付钱。

private equity n. equity in a business that is raised from private sources, as opposed to shares that can be traded publicly 私募股权

veterinary a. /'vetərɪnəri/ Veterinary is used to describe the work of a person whose job is to treat sick or injured animals, or to describe the medical treatment of animals. 兽医的

disclose v. If you disclose new or secret information, you tell people about it. 透露 【考研大纲词汇】

Neither side would **disclose** details of the transaction. 双方都不会透露交易的细节。

monopolisation n. domination (of a market or commodity) to the exclusion of others 垄断

transparency n. [U] the quality of sth, such as a situation or an argument, that makes it easy to understand 易懂; 清楚; 透明度

unaware a. /ˌʌnə'weə(r)/ [not before noun] ~ of sth|~ that... not knowing or realizing that sth is happening or that sth exists 不知道; 没意识到; 未察觉

proposal n. ~ (for sth)|~ (to do sth)|~ (that...) a formal suggestion or plan; the act of making a suggestion 提议; 建议; 动议 【考研大纲词汇】

capping n. 限额

cap v. [often passive] (especially BrE) to limit the amount of money that can be charged for sth or spent on sth 限额收取 (或支出) 【考研大纲词汇】

a **capped mortgage** 限额按揭

prescription n. /pri'skripʃn/~ (for sth) an official piece of paper on which a doctor writes the type of medicine you should have, and which enables you to get it from a chemist's shop/drugstore 处方; 药方 【考研大纲词汇】

were often **unaware** their local vet practice could be owned by an international private equity company.

CMA 最近对兽医诊所的垄断现象展开了调查，发现缺乏竞争和所有权不透明导致了高昂的价格以及客户信息匮乏。与此同时，宠物主人往往不知道，他们当地的兽医诊所可能归一家国际私募股权公司所有。

【 Para.3 】

It found pet owners paid 16.6% more on average at large vet groups than at independent practices. It said the £6.3bn market was not fit for purpose and needed to be modernised.

调查发现，宠物主人在大型兽医集团的平均花费比在独立诊所高出16.6%。报告指出，这个价值63亿英镑的市场存在缺陷，亟需现代化改革。

【 Para.4 】

As a result, the CMA and ministers announced **proposals** in a white paper earlier this summer including the **capping** of **prescriptions** for pets at £21 and more transparency over ownership.

因此，竞争与市场管理局（CMA）和政府部长们于今年夏天早些时候在一份白皮书中公布了相关提案，包括将宠物处方药费用上限设定为 21 英镑，以及提高诊所所有权信息的透明度。

【 Para.5 】

body n. a group of people who work or act together, often for an official purpose, or who are connected in some other way 团体；社团；群体【考研英语大纲词汇】

judicial a. /dʒuːˈdɪʃl/ [usually before noun] connected with a court, a judge or legal judgement 法庭的；法官的；审判的；司法的【考研英语大纲词汇】

wording n. /ˈwɜːdɪŋ/ the words that are used in a piece of writing or speech, especially when they have been carefully chosen 措辞；用词【考研英语大纲词汇】

obscure v. /əbˈskjʊə(r)/ to make it difficult to see, hear or understand sth 使模糊；使隐晦；使费解【考研英语大纲词汇】

We mustn't let these minor details **obscure** the main issue. 我们不能让枝节问题掩盖主要问题。

a. difficult to understand 费解的；难以理解的

I found her lecture very **obscure**. 我觉得她的讲座非常费解。

subsidiary n. /səbˈsɪdiəri/ a business company that is owned or controlled by another larger company 附属公司；子公司

a. ~ (to sth) connected with sth but less important than it 辅助的；附带的；次要的

confectionery n. /kənˈfekʃənəri/ [U] sweets/candy, chocolate, etc. 甜食（糖果、巧克力等）

multinational a. /ˌmʌltiˈnæʃnəl/ existing in or involving many countries 跨国的；涉及多国的

soften v. to become or to make sb/sth more sympathetic and less severe or critical (使) 态度缓和，变温和，变宽厚

She felt herself **softening** towards him. 她感觉自己对他逐渐温和起来。

conglomerate n. /kənˈglɒməreɪt/ [C] (business 商) a large company formed by joining together different firms 联合大公司；企业集团

misleading a. /ˌmɪsˈliːdɪŋ/ giving the wrong idea or impression and making you believe sth that is not true 误导的；引入歧途的【考研英语大纲词汇】

unrecognizable a. /ˌʌnrekəgˈnaɪzəbl/ (of a person or thing 人或事物) so changed or damaged that you do not recognize them or it 变得（或损坏得）难以辨认的；无法识别的

in place phrase working or ready to work 在工作；准备就绪【考研英语大纲词汇】

All the arrangements are now **in place** for their visit. 他们来访的一切都安排就绪了。

workable a. /ˈwɜːkəbl/ (of a system, an idea, etc. 系统、想法等) that can be used successfully and effectively 可行的；行得通的

SYN practical

a **workable plan** 切实可行的计划

But the professional **body** the Progressive Veterinary Association (PVA) has threatened the government agency with a **judicial** review after it changed the **wording** in its plans in a way the PVA says allows multinational companies to **obscure** their ownership of vet practices.

但业内机构“进步兽医协会”（PVA）威胁要对该政府机构提起司法审查，原因是 CMA 在计划中修改了措辞，PVA 认为此举反而允许跨国公司隐瞒其对兽医诊所的所有权。

【 Para.6 】

More than 60% of veterinary practices are owned in whole or in part by six groups: CVS, Pets at Home, Medivet, IVC and VetPartners, which are owned by private equity investors; and Linnaeus, whose parent company is Mars Petcare, a **subsidiary** of the US **confectionery** group Mars.

超过 60%的兽医诊所全部或部分归属于六大集团所有：

CVS、Pets at Home、Medivet、IVC 和 VetPartners（均由私募股权投资者持有）；以及 Linnaeus（其母公司为美国糖果集团玛氏旗下的玛氏宠物护理公司）。

【 Para.7 】

Rather than requiring the name of large **multinational** companies or private equity investors to be listed as the owner of the vet practice, the new rules would allow corporates to use a brand name or the name of the original independent practice.

►今日句子分析

Para 5. But the professional body the Progressive Veterinary Association (PVA) has threatened the government agency with a judicial review after it changed the wording in its plans in a way the PVA says allows multinational companies to obscure their ownership of vet practices. 但业内机构“进步兽医协会”（PVA）威胁要对该政府机构提起司法审查，原因是CMA在计划中修改了措辞，PVA认为此举反而允许跨国公司隐瞒其对兽医诊所的所有权。

主句

But the professional body

(连词) 主语

the Progressive Veterinary Association (PVA)

同位语

has threatened the government agency

谓语 宾语

时间状语从句

with a judicial review after it changed the wording

状语 (连词) 从句主语 谓语 宾语

in its plans in a way the PVA says (省略 that) allows

定语 状语 (插入语) 谓语

multinational companies

宾语

to obscure their ownership of vet practices.

宾补

主句：

(连词) -But；主语-the professional body (body是个多义词，在这里则指“机构”例如She was elected student body president at the University of North Carolina. 她当选为北卡罗莱纳大学学生社团主席。)；同位语-the Progressive Veterinary Association (PVA)；谓语 -has threatened；宾语 -the government agency（阅读中常见各种指代用来避免重复，这里便是指代CMA）；方式状语-with a judicial review；

时间状语从句：

(引导词) -after；从句主语-it（同样会指CMA）；谓语 -changed；宾语-the wording；状语-in its plans；状语-in a way；

定语从句，修饰way（当先行词是way时可以省略引导词that，即从句的主语，补充例句：It doesn't alter the way I feel. 这并没有改变我的感受。）：

(插入语) -the PVA says；谓语-allows；宾语-multinational companies；宾补-to obscure (obscure常用为形容词，但也有动词词性) their ownership of vet practices.

新规不再要求将大型跨国公司或私募股权投资者的名称列为兽医诊所的所有者，而是允许企业使用品牌名称或原独立诊所的名称。

【 Para.8 】

The initial wording of the proposal from the CMA said vets had to disclose their ownership and name the “corporate vet group”. This has been **softened** to “network or group”, meaning the name of the vet practice or subsidiary of the company could be named instead of the **conglomerate**.

CMA 提案的最初措辞要求兽医必须披露所有权信息，并指明“企业兽医集团”的名称。这一要求现已放宽为“网络或集团”，这意味着可以列出兽医诊所或公司子公司的名称，而非该企业集团的名称。

【 Para. 9 】

Dr Iain McGill, a director of the PVA, told the Guardian: “This is bad news for pet owners and their animals. Ultimately, large corporations would be allowed to hide the fact that they are the ultimate controller of local vet practices and operate behind sometimes **misleading** brand names.”

PVA 理事伊恩·麦吉尔 (Iain McGill) 博士对《卫报》表示：“这对宠物主人及其宠物来说是个坏消息。归根结底，大型企业将被允许隐瞒其作为当地兽医诊所最终控制者的事实，并以有时具有误导性的品牌名称进行运营。”

➤ 写作积累

Para.2 The CMA recently ran an investigation into the monopolisation of vet practices and found the lack of competition and transparency of ownership had led to high prices and a lack of information for customers.

动词 run 意为“开展；执行”，等同于 conduct, into...则是修饰 investigation 的定语，这个介词暗含“针对.....”的意思，相较于 on/over/about 这三个也可以泛泛表示“关于.....”的介词来说，into 会更强调“深入挖掘、探究内情”，通常搭配以下几个名词使用：

inquiry n. “调查；询问”，例：an inquiry into safety procedures 关于安全程序的调查

insight n. “见解；洞察”，例：The book gives a fascinating insight into Mrs Blair's character. 这部书对布莱尔夫人的性格作了生动的剖析。

Para.10 Where they have a choice, pet owners often prefer independent practices, ...

where 很多时候会用来作定语从句的引导词，修饰某个地点，但它其实也可以单拎出来作条件状语从句的引导词，表示“在.....的情况/场合下”，有时可以与 if 换用，例：

Where there is a will, there is a way. 有志者，事竟成。

Where people were concerned, his threshold of boredom was low. 涉及人的事情，他便极易感到厌烦。

【 Para.10 】

He added: “Where they have a choice, pet owners often prefer independent practices, which the CMA found on average to be cheaper than corporate practices.”

他补充道：“在有选择的情况下，宠物主人通常更倾向于独立诊所，而 CMA 发现，独立诊所的平均费用通常低于企业连锁诊所。”

【 Para.11 】

The CMA told vets who complained that the disclosure of the ultimate parent company names might not be of any meaningful benefit to pet owners. It added that these corporate names could be **unrecognisable** and that pet owners were more familiar with the high street vet or pet company names.

CMA 向提出投诉的兽医表示，披露最终母公司名称可能对宠物主人没有任何实质性益处。该机构补充称，这些企业名称可能鲜为人知，而宠物主人更熟悉的是街边兽医诊所或宠物公司的名称。

【 Para.12 】

However, the PVA argued that pet owners had the right to know if their local vet practice was owned by a large conglomerate.

然而，PVA 认为，宠物主人有权知晓他们当地的兽医诊所是否属于大型企业集团所有。

【 Para.13 】

A CMA spokesperson said: “It is critical that pet owners know whether their local practice is part of a national group or locally owned, and we are confident the changes we are making will achieve this.

CMA 发言人表示：“宠物主人知晓当地诊所是隶属于全国性集团，还是本地独立经营的诊所，这一点至关重要。我们相信我们正在推行的改革将实现这一目标。

【 Para.14 】

“In future, all practices will have to make ownership links clear by using brand names that people recognise on signs and online.

“今后，所有诊所都必须在招牌和网络上使用公众熟知的品牌名称，以明确所有权关系。

【 Para.15 】

“Our proposals were supported by large and small vet practices and consumer groups, and we made our decision on this in our final report in March.

“我们的提案得到了大小规模兽医诊所及消费者团体的支持，我们已在 3 月份的最终报告中就此作出了决定。

【 Para.16 】

“We’re now considering comments on exactly how the changes should be put **in place** to make sure they are clear and **workable** for pet owners and vets.”

“我们目前正在考虑各方意见，以确定具体如何落实这些变更，确保其对宠物主人和兽医而言既清晰又切实可行。”